

AUDIO TRENDS AND TECHNOLOGIES

The India multi-room audio market is projected at approximately \$5 billion in 2025, growing at a 15% CAGR through 2033 as consumers demand seamless streaming across every room. High-resolution audio formats – such as FLAC, ALAC, and MQA – are gaining traction among audiophiles, with global home audio equipment revenue climbing from \$41.6 billion in 2024 to \$46.1 billion in 2025.

Nearly 36.7 million speaker units will ship in India in 2025, up from 32 million the year prior, driven by rising interest in premium wireless speakers. Wireless audio devices supporting Qualcomm aptX Adaptive and Sony LDAC codecs ensure near-CD quality over Bluetooth, minimizing compression artifacts in personal listening.

Smart assistants have become integral to audio control: over 30% of Indian households now use voice commands via Alexa, Google Assistant, or Siri to manage music playback. The India wireless audio

market itself is forecast to grow at a CAGR of 17.2 % through 2030, led by brands like boAt, Sony, and Bose. Integration with mesh Wi-Fi systems ensures stable multi-room synchronization and reduces dropouts in dense urban environments.

Emerging standards like Wi-Fi 6E and Thread promise even lower latency and broader device interoperability. Subscription-based lossless streaming options on platforms such as Tidal and Amazon Music HD are expanding in India, bolstering demand for high-fidelity gear. Advanced room-EQ solutions – Audyssey, Dirac Live, and proprietary DSP – automatically measure and correct room acoustics for flatter response curves.

Finally, modular audio ecosystems now let users start with a single smart speaker and scale to full surround or multi-zone systems without rewiring. These innovations complement your core audio setup, delivering greater flexibility, fidelity, and future-readiness.

and streaming devices through HDMI 2.1 eARC ports to maintain audio quality and low latency.

- **Network Configuration:** For streaming devices, use wired Gigabit Ethernet or Wi-Fi 6 to minimize buffering and audio dropouts.



Final listening and adjustments

1. **Speaker Levels:** Play calibrated pink noise through your receiver's setup menu or use an SPL meter to ensure each channel reads within ± 1 dB at the listening position.
2. **Dialogue Enhancement:** If dialogue feels recessed, increase the center channel level by +2 dB increments until speech is clear without overpowering effects.

3. **Bass Level Balancing:** Adjust the subwoofer trim on your AVR or soundbar so that bass is impactful but not boomy – use reference film or music tracks for subjective confirmation.
4. **Dynamic Range Control:** For late-night listening, enable dynamic range compression ("Night Mode") to reduce loud peaks while preserving intelligibility.

6. Audio gear maintenance and upgrades

- **Firmware Updates:** Check manufacturer apps quarterly to keep DSP, room EQ, and connectivity features current.
- **Dust and Ventilation:** Use microfiber cloths to clean speaker grilles; ensure subwoofer vents remain dust-free to prevent overheating.
- **Cables and Connections:** Inspect HDMI and speaker cables annually for wear; replace any showing frayed shielding or loose contacts.
- **Future Upgrades:** Consider adding height channels for Dolby Atmos, replacing passive speakers with powered monitors for cleaner amplification, or integrating a dedicated DAC/amp for audiophile-grade music playback.

By systematically selecting, placing, and calibrating each component – soundbars, speakers, and subwoofers – you'll unlock a home audio experience that's rich, immersive, and tailored to your space. In the next chapter, we'll explore portable listening solutions – headphones and TWS earbuds – that let you take this fidelity on the go. 